Global Trade Intelligence Report — Week of October 5–12, 2026

Weekly briefing. Coverage window: October 5–12, 2026. Compiled from approximately 45 trade news, policy, data, and freight sources worldwide.

Table of contents

1. Executive summary
2. Alerts
3. Top stories — deep dives
4. Tariff tracker
5. US policy deep dive
6. World policy by region
7. Enforcement actions
8. Data releases
9. Freight market
10. Policy timelines
11. Upcoming deadlines & events (next 90 days)
12. Sources & methodology

---

1. Executive summary

Energy security, trade defence, and maritime security collided this week. Three developments set the tone:

- **The Graham Act countdown entered its final week.** With the October 18 tariff-determination deadline days away, President Trump announced a Russian diesel import deal of more than 300,000 tonnes immediately and 500,000 more in November, authorised by Treasury's General License 135 through April 2027, even as the Act's secondary tariffs of up to 100% on top Russian-energy buyers stand ready to take effect absent presidential waivers. Seven bipartisan senators called the deal inconsistent with the sanctions law the President signed. India, the largest buyer of Russian crude, said its US trade-deal talks have "reached a plateau."
- **The EU–China Beijing round produced a contested outcome.** Commissioner Maroš Šefčovič announced a "shared understanding" to more than halve Chinese hybrid exports to the EU over four years, plus Chinese tariff cuts on car parts, olive oil and footwear worth at least €225M in duty savings. Beijing's published text carries no such figure, and the EU's goods deficit with China reached €238B in the first seven months of 2026. France and Germany separately proposed a rapid-reaction EU trade weapon "as powerful as Section 301." EU leaders decide next steps at the Brussels summit on October 15.

- **The energy-shipping war escalated.** The Houthis declared a maritime embargo on Saudi Arabia and struck two Saudi airports, killing three. Bab el-Mandeb traffic fell to 11 vessels on October 11. Tanker attacks around Hormuz hit their highest weekly level since the war began; the US sanctioned 22 more tankers and Iran called the US reply to its Hormuz-reopening proposal "insufficient."

Elsewhere: US container imports set a September record (2.55M TEU, up 10.3% YoY, per Descartes' October 8 report); CBP launched Phase 3 of the IEEPA tariff refund process through its Consolidated Administration and Processing of Entries (CAPE) system on October 6; the UK said a decision on tariffs of up to 45% on Chinese EVs is "finely balanced"; the WTO raised its 2026 merchandise trade forecast to 3.9% on AI-driven demand while UNCTAD's flagship report described "selective fragmentation" and a 20% decline in China–US trade since 2024; China opened an anti-dumping probe into EU p-nitrotoluene; and Japan's expanded Russia export ban takes effect October 16.

Freight: a post-peak unwind with conflict premia. The Drewry World Container Index fell 2% to $4,351/FEU, with Asia–Europe down 13 straight weeks as carriers accelerate their Suez return and the restored capacity pressures rates. The Baltic Dry Index fell 7.3% to 2,917 as Capesize earnings collapsed on soft iron ore. Hapag-Lloyd suspended all bookings to Manila through year-end as the Philippines empties crisis choked yard capacity. Global schedule reliability fell below 50% for the first time since the pandemic.

---

2. Alerts

#	Alert	Effective	Impact	Source
A1	Graham Act secondary-tariff deadline: up to 500% duties on Russian goods; up to 100% secondary tariffs on top Russian-energy buyers without waiver	Oct 18, 2026	India, China, Türkiye most exposed; duties stack on existing tariffs	mondaq.com
A2	US–Russia diesel deal: 300,000+ tonnes immediately, 500,000 tonnes in November; OFAC General License 135 authorises Russian diesel imports	Oct 9, 2026 (GL135 valid to Apr 7, 2027)	Political collision with Graham Act one week before deadline; 7 senators urge reversal	nationpress.com
A3	EU–China Beijing round: contested hybrid-export "understanding"; €225M+ tariff cuts on EU exports; rare-earth green channel preserved	Oct 8–9, 2026 (decision at EU summit Oct 15)	Enforcement mechanism undisclosed; Beijing's text gives no halving figure	eureporter.co
A4	Franco-German proposal for EU rapid-reaction trade instrument "as powerful as Section 301"	Proposal Oct 5; summit Oct 15	Potential EU trade-defence upgrade; China warns of response	lapost.com
A5	Houthi maritime embargo on Saudi Arabia; Bab el-Mandeb traffic at months-low (11 vessels	Oct 9–11, 2026	Saudi crude loadings threatened; 7+ tankers rerouted	marinelink.com

#	Alert	Effective	Impact	Source
	Oct 11); strikes on two Saudi airports, three killed			
A6	Hormuz/Gulf tanker attacks at highest weekly level since war began; US sanctions 22 more tankers (Oct 8)	Oct 7–11, 2026	Blockade-runner disabled by US Oct 10; chemical tanker struck off Qatar	gcaptain.com
A7	China rare-earth export-control suspension expires; no extension announced	Nov 10, 2026	Automatic snapback unless both sides extend; $6.5T/year downstream production at risk (IEA)	investornews.com
A8	UK weighing tariffs of up to 45% on Chinese EVs; decision "finely balanced"	Under consideration (reported Oct 4–7)	58% of UK auto exports go to EU; tied to "Made in Europe" access	fleetnews.co.uk
A9	CBP launches Phase 3 of IEEPA tariff refund process (CAPE)	Oct 6, 2026	Operational start of refund execution for finally liquidated entries; scope for non-litigating importers contested; comments due Nov 4	thompsonhine.com
A10	Hapag-Lloyd suspends all bookings to Manila, Batangas and Subic through year-end on empties congestion	Immediate (through Dec 31, 2026)	One of the severest carrier booking actions of 2026	portcalls.com
A11	China anti-dumping probe into EU p-nitrotoluene opened	Oct 3 (registration closes Oct 23)	Dumping margins alleged above 100%; retaliatory timing vs EU tool proposal	mlex.com
A12	Japan expanded Russia export ban takes effect	Oct 16, 2026	Additional goods barred from Russia-bound export	globalsanctions.com

A1 — Graham Act deadline (detail)

The Lindsey O. Graham Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act of 2026 (signed September 18) sets a 30-day implementation deadline of **October 18, 2026** for two mandatory tariff tracks. Section 112: duties of up to **500% ad valorem** on all goods imported from Russia, explicitly including petroleum products. Section 113: duties of up to **100% ad valorem** on all goods from countries that were among the five largest importers of Russian crude oil or natural gas in the preceding 12 months and that knowingly make new purchases on or after the deadline. All duties stack on existing Section 301/232 duties. The escape valves are narrow: a presidential waiver requiring a formal, unclassified written certification to Congress that it serves the national interest, and a limited natural-gas exception (imports under 15% of Russia's total annual gas exports plus "significant steps" to reduce them; crude-oil buyers do not qualify). Law-firm analysis names China, India and Türkiye as the likely targets, with Slovakia, Hungary and the UAE at elevated risk. (mondaq.com)

A2 — The Russian diesel deal (detail)

On October 9, following a call with President Putin, President Trump announced that Russia would supply diesel to US and global markets: more than **300,000 tonnes immediately and another 500,000 tonnes in November**, to bring down fuel prices for farmers, ranchers and truckers. Treasury's Office of Foreign Assets Control issued **General License 135** authorising transactions in Russian-origin diesel until 12:01 a.m. EDT on **April 7, 2027** (the license sets no volume cap; the tonnage figures come from the announcement itself). Treasury Secretary Bessent said the administration would act under its available legal authorities and disputed that the Graham Act bars the deal. The Act preserves Treasury's general-license authority, and Section 113 counts only crude oil and natural gas, not refined products, when determining which countries face tariffs. Seven senators from both parties, led by ranking member Jeanne Shaheen with Sens. Tillis, Collins, Murkowski, Curtis, Blumenthal and Wyden, issued a joint statement on October 11 urging reversal, arguing the deal contradicts the sanctions framework Congress established. Context: diesel prices have climbed steeply since February on the Iran conflict, Russia's export ban and Ukrainian refinery strikes; AAA put the national average near $6.27–6.28/gallon on October 8–9. (nationpress.com, cnn.com, egyptoil-gas.com, mondaq.com)

A3 — EU–China Beijing round (detail)

The second session of the EU–China Trade and Investment Consultations concluded October 9 in Beijing between Commissioner Maroš Šefčovič and Minister Wang Wentao, after three months of talks over a goods deficit running above €1B per day. Šefčovič announced a "shared understanding" to moderate China's exports of hybrid and plug-in hybrid vehicles that "opens the prospect of cutting China's exports by more than a half" over four years, alongside understandings to lower MFN tariffs covering car parts, olive oil and footwear (nearly €4B in current EU export value, at least €225M in duty savings) and to make China's rare-earth export licensing smoother and more predictable, with the green channel preserved. **The caveat:** Beijing's published text gives no figure on hybrid exports. The "halving" exists only in Šefčovič's remarks, the mechanism is undisclosed, and it needs political endorsement from EU leaders at the October 15–16 summit. Context: China refused to voluntarily restrict hybrid-car exports (FT, citing two diplomats, October 7); the European Parliament voted October 7 to denounce China's economic practices and its position on Ukraine. (eureporter.co, reuters.com, europeansting.com)

A5/A6 — Maritime security escalation (detail)

The Houthi military spokesman declared a maritime embargo against Saudi Arabia. On October 10–11, Houthi strikes hit two Saudi airports, killing three and injuring dozens. Bab el-Mandeb traffic fell on October 11 to **11 commodity vessels, the lowest level in months**, including seven oil tankers; at least seven tankers altered course after the embargo warning. The embargo directly threatens Saudi crude loadings on the Red Sea flank.

Around Hormuz, tanker attacks hit their highest weekly level since the war began. At least 12 oil and gas tankers were attacked between September 28 and October 5 (Reuters), and shipbroker Gibson has tracked **95 attacks on tankers** since the war began (via Breakwave

Advisors, October 12). The geography is widening beyond the strait: on October 7 the Antigua and Barbuda-flagged chemical tanker *Acers* was struck by multiple projectiles about 51 nautical miles north of Madinat ash Shamal, Qatar, with casualties reported (UKMTO). A second commercial vessel was struck inside the Persian Gulf on October 9. On October 8 the US imposed sanctions on 22 more tankers linked to Iran's oil trade; press reports said G7 partners agreed to make emergency oil and diesel stocks available (October 2). On October 10 the US military said it disabled a cargo vessel in the Gulf of Oman attempting to run the Iran blockade. Iran said on October 11 that the US response to its seven-condition proposal to reopen Hormuz was "insufficient." (marinelink.com, gcaptain.com, splash247.com, hellenicshippingnews.com)

---

3. Top stories — deep dives

3.1 EU–China: a "half-deal" with no shared text

The second round of the EU–China Trade and Investment Consultations in Beijing (October 8–9) ended with a joint statement and a 16-point consensus list covering hybrid vehicles, tariff relief, rare earths, the EU's antisubsidy EV probe, Foreign Subsidies Regulation technical talks, and IP cooperation. A ministerial video meeting is set for January, with the next in-person round in March 2027. That is the procedural skeleton. The substance is thinner than the announcement suggests.

Two texts, one summit. Šefčovič's headline claim is a shared understanding to more than halve Chinese hybrid exports over four years, with tariff cuts covering nearly **€4B** of EU exports and at least **€225M** in duty savings. Beijing's published text gives no figure. The halving exists only in the Commissioner's briefing, the enforcement mechanism is undisclosed, and none of it is policy until the European Council endorses it on October 15–16. The numbers behind the urgency are not in dispute: the EU goods deficit with China hit **€238.06B in the first seven months of 2026**, 12.2% wider year-on-year, and Chinese car imports run at roughly **€1B per day** in trade-flow terms. (mlex.com)

Why the summit matters. If implemented, this would be the first voluntary export moderation arrangement of this scale in EU–China trade: a China-accepted VER without a prior tariff fight, in Šefčovič's framing, and a potential template for other sectors. But five days before the round, Beijing opened an anti-dumping probe into EU p-nitrotoluene (October 3), and MOFCOM noted the EU has opened 28 trade-remedy cases against China since 2025. The parallel Franco-German rapid-reaction proposal heads to the same summit. The summit will decide whether the hybrid understanding becomes policy or remains a press-conference claim.

3.2 Graham Act: a sanctions law on a collision course with its own administration

With the October 18 deadline one week out, the administration licensed Russian diesel imports (General License 135, through April 7, 2027) while the Graham Act's secondary-

tariff machinery stands ready to penalise Russian-energy purchases by India, China and Türkiye. Seven bipartisan senators demanded reversal. India, the world's largest buyer of Russian crude at ~1.6M bpd and accounting for 37% of Russia's crude exports from December 2022 through August 2026 (CREA data), said its US trade-deal talks have "reached a plateau" (Finance Minister Sitharaman, October 5) and stressed energy security for its 1.4 billion people. China rejected "long-arm jurisdiction" (Foreign Ministry, September 19, reiterated this week); no Turkish government response was identified this week. Türkiye buys roughly 282,000 bpd, well behind India (~1.6M) and China (~1.3M, Kpler).

The arithmetic is stark. Secondary duties run up to **100%** on goods of top Russian-energy buyers and up to **500%** on Russian goods, both stacking on existing Section 301/232 duties. The diesel deal covers 300,000+ tonnes immediately and 500,000 in November, about a day and a half of US demand, against diesel prices up steeply since February. The natural-gas exception (imports under 15% of Russia's total annual gas exports plus "significant steps" to reduce) does not help crude buyers.

The waiver is the whole game. The diesel deal makes the Act's application visibly discretionary: Washington imports Russian refined products while threatening up to 100% secondary duties on third countries buying Russian crude. The Act's text supports the distinction (Section 113 counts only crude and natural gas), but the seven senators' statement shows the political cost. Administration intent on waivers remains unstated, leaving importers sourcing from India, China and Türkiye with acute planning uncertainty. The waiver decision, due by October 18, is now the single most consequential tariff event of the autumn.

3.3 The energy-shipping war enters a new phase

Two escalations unfolded at once: the Houthis' declared embargo on Saudi Arabia with strikes on Saudi airports (three killed, October 9–10), and the highest weekly level of Hormuz-area tanker attacks since the war began. The geography of risk is widening. Attacks have broadened to the Gulf of Oman and the Arabian Gulf beyond the Hormuz chokepoint, while the Red Sea embargo threatens the other flank of Gulf crude exports. The week's data points: **95 tanker attacks** since the war began (Gibson, via Breakwave); 22 more tankers sanctioned by the US on October 8; Bab el-Mandeb down to 11 commodity vessels on October 11, the lowest in months, with 7+ tankers rerouted; the Strait of Hormuz closed to shippers since February 28. The US disabled a blockade-runner on October 10.

Paradoxically, crude kept moving. Middle East crude exports ran above pre-war levels in late September (Kpler via Reuters, October 5), a reminder that the improvised relay of shuttle tankers and Hormuz-bypass pipelines is holding for now. But the EU's Aspides escort operation has acknowledged available warships are insufficient to cover all requests, a hard constraint on any further container return to Suez. For importers, the combination of elevated freight, sanctions churn and two simultaneous maritime embargoes is now the central cost variable, not a tail risk.

3.4 The data duel: Washington's deficit widens while Geneva upgrades the outlook

The Census Bureau and BEA released August US trade data on October 6: the deficit widened to **$105.6B** (+13.7%), with imports at a monthly record of **$420.8B**. Two days later, the WTO raised its 2026 merchandise trade volume forecast to **3.9%** (from 1.9% in March) on AI-driven demand. On October 9, UNCTAD released its flagship Trade and Development Report 2026: world trade hit a record **$35T** in 2025, but the report describes "selective fragmentation," with China–US trade down more than 20% since 2024 and developing countries locked out of strategic sectors by export controls and investment screening.

Three releases, one argument. Demand is strong (record US imports), its composition is narrow (AI goods drove nearly half of trade growth; concentration flagged by UNCTAD), and its geography is selective (China–US trade down over 20% since 2024 while Mexico, Vietnam and Taiwan fill the gap). The numbers:

- US August deficit: $105.6B (+$12.7B m/m); goods deficit $136.6B; imports record $420.8B; largest bilateral gaps: Mexico ($27.7B), Vietnam ($24.0B), Taiwan ($18.3B), China ($16.4B). Jan–Aug cumulative deficit still **19.9% narrower** y/y — one wide month against a narrower annual trend.
- WTO: merchandise volume **3.9% in 2026** (from 1.9%), 4.1% in 2027; services cut to 3.3% (from 4.8%) on Middle East conflict; AI-enabling goods (chips, servers) drove **47%** of trade growth and rose 67% y/y, now ~14.8% of world goods trade. Regional 2026 merchandise exports: Asia +9.9%, North America +5.7%, Africa +5.6%, South America +3.4%, Europe −0.1%, CIS −3.9%, Middle East −17.2%. World GDP 2.6% (2026), 2.9% (2027).
- UNCTAD: global GDP 2.6% in 2026 (from 2.9% in 2025); Asia to contribute **60%** of growth; India 7.3%; strategic investment share rose from 16% to 44% of announced greenfield investment (2020–2025), with ~70% going to developed economies. ODA projected to fall almost 7% in 2026, a third straight annual decline.
- UNCTAD's October Global Trade Update projects 2026 merchandise trade growth at just **1.5–2.5% in real terms**, down from 4.7% in 2025 — the lowest since 2023 — a deliberate counterpoint to the WTO's volume upgrade.

```
%%{init: {'theme': 'base', 'themeVariables': {'xyChart': {'plotColorPalette':
'#2563eb'}}}}%%
xychart-beta
    title "WTO 2026 merchandise trade volume forecast revision"
    x-axis ["March forecast", "October update"]
    y-axis "%" 0 --> 5
    bar [1.9, 3.9]
```

```
%%{init: {'theme': 'base', 'themeVariables': {'xyChart': {'plotColorPalette':
'#e76f51'}}}}%%
xychart-beta
    title "US monthly trade deficit, August 2026"
    x-axis ["July", "August (record imports $420.8B)"]
    y-axis "$B" 0 --> 120
    bar [92.8, 105.6]
```

```
%%{init: {'theme': 'base', 'themeVariables': {'xyChart': {'plotColorPalette':
'#e76f51'}}}}%%
xychart-beta
    title "Largest US bilateral goods deficits, Aug 2026 ($B)"
    x-axis ["Mexico", "Vietnam", "Taiwan", "China"]
    y-axis "$B" 0 --> 32
    bar [27.7, 24.0, 18.3, 16.4]
```

The divergence between the WTO's volume optimism and UNCTAD's real-terms caution, price-driven nominal gains versus weak real volumes, is the analytical frame for the quarter. The IMF's October WEO, due during the Bangkok Annual Meetings (October 12–18), will carry the formal tariff-simulation assessment. (bea.gov, reuters.com, dig.watch, un.org)

3.5 Rare earths: the November 10 snapback

China's suspension of its expanded rare-earth export controls expires **November 10, 2026**, with no extension announced. The April 2025 controls on seven elements were never suspended. **November 10 is automatic**: unless both governments extend their pauses, the controls snap back. Three paths from here are extension, selective reactivation, or full restoration.

The stakes, in the IEA's estimate: full implementation could put an estimated **$6.5T/year** of downstream production outside China at risk. China supplied 70% of US yttrium imports 2021–2024; US net-import reliance for yttrium was 100% in 2025 (USGS). Washington is building leverage of its own: Reuters reported October 1 that Commerce has slowed export licenses for aircraft parts bound for China, including shipments to state-owned COMAC, and is considering new rules on landing gear and hydraulic-fluid licensing. On the Western supply side, a four-bill congressional package on stockpiles and permitting advanced this week alongside new mine and processing investments.

Beijing's May 2026 summit pledge to "address US concerns" has produced no formal extension, and rare-earth shipments have not returned to agreed levels. The Beijing round's promise of a "smoother, more predictable" licensing green channel for European companies will be tested against the snapback date.

3.6 Fifteen economies align on overcapacity — outside the WTO

On October 7, trade ministers of 15 economies (the US, Argentina, Australia, Canada, the EU, France, Germany, India, Italy, Japan, South Korea, Mexico, Poland, Türkiye and the UK) signed a Joint Ministerial Statement calling for action to eliminate structural excess capacity and "non-market" policies encouraging overproduction. It grew out of the Milwaukee G20 Trade Ministers' meeting (September 30–October 1), where no consensus was reached, and was agreed on the sidelines of an OECD Trade Committee meeting. It promises dedicated sector-specific platforms, technical meetings before December, and shared information.

Fifteen sign, seven sit out. This is the largest coalition statement on overcapacity this year, and it institutionalises a non-WTO, plurilateral monitoring track. The non-signatories

matter as much as the signatories: China, Russia, Brazil, Indonesia, Saudi Arabia, South Africa and the African Union did not sign, and China warned on October 9 that it would respond "as necessary" if the statement were used as a pretext for measures harming its interests. Brazil's absence, a major G20 member facing US Section 301 tariffs, is notable. The pre-December technical meetings are now a watchpoint. (reuters.com)

3.7 US importers keep buying: record September boxes

Descartes' October Global Shipping Report (released October 8) showed US container imports of **2,546,261 TEU in September**, the highest September on record, up 10.3% YoY (Reuters/Descartes; Descartes reports a 2.2% MoM dip vs August). China-origin imports were 924,454 TEU, up 4.5% MoM per Descartes and +21.2% YoY per Reuters, accounting for 36.3% of total volume. Retail categories (plastic goods, furniture/bedding, toys/sporting goods) dominated Chinese shipments. Jan–Sep 2026 volume is up 0.8% vs 2025, the first cumulative gain over 2025 this year.

Demand refuses the memo. Despite the tariff regime, US import demand stays strong. Corroboration arrived from the ports: Port of LA handled a record 1.04M TEU in September (Gene Seroka, October 9); Port of Savannah a record 504,015 TEU (+3.7% YoY, October 7). NRF's Global Port Tracker projects August was the 2026 peak month; imports are "likely past the busiest part of the year" (JOC, October 8). The FT-900's record $420.8B of August imports and Descartes' September record boxes point the same way: supply chains are rerouting (Mexico, Vietnam, Taiwan bilateral gaps now larger than China's) rather than reshoring. (reuters.com)

3.8 Air and surface: a muted peak with one exception

Air: a muted peak. Xeneta data showed global air cargo volumes grew **+4% in October** against expectations of a flat market, but Europe–North America demand fell **−6% YoY**, "a harsh signal" and a possible bellwether. China–Europe e-commerce shipments surged **+62% YoY** in September while China–US e-commerce fell **−34%** (fifth straight month, moderating from −49% in June). TAC Index September: Hong Kong–North America $7.02/kg (+31% YoY), Hong Kong–Europe $4.80/kg (+8.8%); the Baltic Air Freight Index rose 25.5% YoY. The EU's new €3-per-package charge on sub-€150 shipments is weighing on Asia–Europe volumes. Dimerco's October report predicts ocean congestion and held-back China–US cargo could push more volume into air in Q4; Xeneta sees a muted peak. Wildcard: strikes on Saudi airports cut Riyadh's outbound air cargo capacity by a third as peak looms. (airfreight.news)

Trucking: fuel, not freight. Truckload contract rates hit a 52-week high of **$2.72/mile** plus fuel (+18% YoY); dry-van spot $3.55/mile all-in, ~50% above year-ago, driven by fuel and capacity tightness, not demand. Diesel hit $6.39/gal. Outbound tender rejections ~13.75–14%. New capacity is shrinking: tractors in new for-hire fleets fell to 19,520 in August (−14% vs H1 average); only ~2 in 3 new interstate registrants buy liability insurance (vs 9 in 10 in 2019). Old Dominion's 4.9% GRI took effect October 5; DHL Express joined FedEx at 5.9% 2027 GRI (January 1). (freightwaves.com)

---

4. Tariff tracker

Country	Measure	Rate	Effective date	Status	Source
US → Canada	Section 338 additional tariffs	50% (no USMCA exemption)	Aug 22, 2026 (re-scoped Sept 15)	In force	whitehouse.gov
US → Canada	Section 338 import bans (motorcycles, whey, molasses, nonalcoholic beer, alcohol, dairy)	Import denied entry (in-transit goods: 50% duty)	Sept 29, 2026	In force	asrwe.com
US → Canada	Section 301 forced-labor tariff	10% (avoidable with valid USMCA claim; non-USMCA covered goods face 50%+10%=60%)	Jul 23, 2026	In force; 25-state lawsuit pending, no ruling	jdsupra.com
Canada → US	Counter-tariffs on ~335 tariff items (steel, aluminum, dairy, autos, appliances, agricultural equipment, paper, plastics, electronics)	15% / 25% / 50%	Sept 8, 2026	In force	surtaxscan.com
US → Russia	Graham Act Section 112 duties on all Russian goods incl. petroleum	Up to 500%	Deadline Oct 18, 2026	Pending; waivers possible	mondaq.com
US → top Russian-energy buyers (India, China, Türkiye, others)	Graham Act Section 113 secondary tariffs	Up to 100% (stacks on all existing duties)	Deadline Oct 18, 2026	Pending; presidential waiver requires unclassified certification to Congress	mondaq.com
US → Russia	OFAC General License 135: Russian diesel imports authorised	n/a (licence)	Oct 9, 2026 – Apr 7, 2027	In force	nationpress.com

Country	Measure	Rate	Effective date	Status	Source
China → EU (p-nitrotoluene)	Anti-dumping investigation (MOFCOM Announcement No. 44)	Alleged dumping margin >100% (provisional duties tbd)	Opened Oct 3, 2026; registration closes Oct 23	Investigation open	mlex.com
EU → China	Hybrid/PHEV export moderation — "shared understanding"	Voluntary export restraint (halving claimed by Šefčovič; no figure in Beijing text)	Outcome decided at EU summit Oct 15–16	Pending political endorsement	eureporter.co
UK → China	Tariffs on Chinese-made EVs	Up to 45% (matching EU combined rate)	Under consideration	Not decided ("finely balanced")	fleetnews.co.uk
Brazil	Zero duties: microphones, musical instruments, household sewing machines	0% (from 18–20%)	Oct 1, 2026	In force	datamarnews.com
US	Section 232 polysilicon & derivatives	MIPs: $21/kg poly, $100/kg wafers, $0.22/W cells, $0.38/W modules + 15% ad valorem	Dec 4, 2026 (anti-surge rules in force since Sept 22)	Scheduled	mondaq.com
US → China	Section 301 Lists 2 & 3 (2018 actions)	7.5%–25%	In force (USTR concluded second four-year review Oct 7, tariffs continue)	In force	internationaltradetoday.com
US → ~60 economies	Section 301 forced-labor tariffs	10% tier (17 economies incl. Canada, India, Mexico, UK); 12.5% remainder; EU/Taiwan capped at 10% combined	Jul 23, 2026	In force; 3 lawsuits pending	jdsupra.com
US → ~60 economies (proposed TRQ)	ASEAN tariff-rate quota (Bangladesh, Cambodia, Indonesia, Malaysia) for	tbd	Under consideration	Proposal stage	asiadaily.org

Country	Measure	Rate	Effective date	Status	Source
	goods with US cotton/textile inputs — exemption from Section 301 forced-labor tariffs				
US	BIS "U.S. content" guidance: USMCA mobile industrial equipment (Proclamation 11032) — tariff reduction 25% → 15% floor where ≥40% US content	Effective rate 15% floor	Effective Oct 14, 2026 (FR publication)	Scheduled	kpmg.com
India	Chromium trioxide — final affirmative CVD	n/a	Oct 8, 2026 (US measure)	Final determination issued	federalregister.gov
China	CBS (rubber accelerator) — preliminary affirmative CVD + critical circumstances	n/a	Oct 8, 2026 (US measure)	Preliminary determination issued	federalregister.gov
China	Amine compounds — AD/CVD investigations instituted (alleged margins up to 476%)	tbd	ITC prelim due Nov 13, 2026	Investigations open	federalregister.gov
Mexico	Railway tank cars — AD/CVD investigations instituted	tbd	ITC prelim due Nov 16, 2026	Investigations open	federalregister.gov
Japan	Expanded export ban on goods for Russia's industrial base	Export prohibition	Oct 16, 2026	Scheduled	globalsanctions.com

```
%%{init: {'theme': 'base', 'themeVariables': {'xyChart': {'plotColorPalette':
'#1e3a5f'}}}}%%
xychart-beta
```

```
    title "Highest tariff rates on the table (% ad valorem)"
    x-axis ["G112 Russia", "Amines AD", "G113 2ndary", "p-nitro AD", "Sec338 CA", "CA
counter", "UK China EV", "301 L2/L3"]
    y-axis "%" 0 --> 550
    bar [500, 476, 100, 100, 50, 50, 45, 25]
```

Maximum stated rates ('up to' where proposed; AD = alleged anti-dumping margin).

---

5. US policy deep dive

US–Canada: stalemate with legal clouds

No new Section 338 proclamations were issued in the window. Standing measures: **50% additional Section 338 tariffs** on Canadian goods (in force since August 22; second set effective September 15 covering paper, furniture, cheese, leather, motorboats, golf carts, steel, aluminum and base metal products, duties apply regardless of USMCA origin; energy, potash, Section 232-covered goods, fish and critical minerals excluded); **import bans** effective September 29 on motorcycles, whey, molasses, nonalcoholic beer, alcohol and dairy (roughly $967M); Canada's mirrored **15%/25%/50% counter-tariffs** on roughly C$27.6B of US goods (steel, aluminum, dairy, autos, appliances, agricultural equipment, paper, plastics, electronics) effective September 8; and the September 8 presidential directive to GSA (with USTR) to remove Canadian-origin products from GSA Multiple Award Schedules.

This week's developments: the Montreal Economic Institute published an October 8 note (Phillip W. Magness) arguing Canada's counter-tariffs may weaken US legal challenges to the Section 338 tariffs; legal commentary continues to argue Section 338 may have been superseded by the Trade Expansion Act of 1962 and the Trade Act of 1974, raising major-questions and nondelegation issues, but **no court case has yet been filed** directly challenging the Section 338 tariffs. Separately, the **25-state lawsuit** over the July 2026 Section 301 forced-labor tariffs (three lawsuits total challenge the 10–12.5% duties on ~60 economies) had **no written ruling as of October 4**. On the negotiating track, USTR Greer described Canada's remaining sticking points (autos, dairy, alcoholic beverages) as "quite difficult" and said Washington is "not inclined" to go to a zero tariff; Prime Minister Carney disclosed Ottawa had been prepared to remove remaining counter-tariffs on steel, aluminum and autos if Washington substantially lowered its own, and to encourage provinces to return US alcohol to shelves, but would not change the supply-management system. Canada has signalled restraint rather than further escalation. (iedm.org, akingump.com, hashtag investing)

IEEPA refunds: Phase 3 begins

CBP opened **Phase 3 of its court-ordered IEEPA tariff refund process** on **October 6** through CAPE, the Consolidated Administration and Processing of Entries system. Phase 3 covers finally liquidated entries (past the 80-day window) for importers that are plaintiffs in pending Court of International Trade cases and whose entries are covered by a reliquidation

order, notably Senior Judge Eaton's July 17 order covering plaintiffs in roughly 3,700 IEEPA cases. Plaintiffs that submitted their importer-of-record numbers by July 30, 2026 could file from October 6; later submitters file on a rolling biweekly basis. The federal government is appealing the breadth of the reliquidation authority, so relief for non-litigating importers with older liquidated entries remains contested. CBP is accepting additional public comments on the refund information collection through **November 4** (Reginfo.gov). This is the operational execution of the IEEPA tariff refunds ordered after the Supreme Court's February 20, 2026 ruling in *Learning Resources, Inc. v. Trump* that IEEPA does not authorize tariffs; CBP had accepted roughly $137B in potential and certified refunds for processing as of early October. Yale Budget Lab estimates the temporary positive fiscal impulse from IEEPA refunds approximately offsets the negative growth impacts of the remaining tariffs for 2026. (thompsonhine.com, jdsupra.com, greatlakescustomslaw.com)

CBP operations

- **FY2027 customs user fees (effective October 1):** the Customs Broker Permit User Fee rose from $185.38 to **$190.88**; the Merchandise Processing Fee rate remains **0.3464%**, with minimum and maximum limits increased. (ghy.com)
- **Low-value shipments (RIN 1685-AA38):** CBP opened a consultation on **October 8** on proposed changes to informal customs entry requirements for low-value shipments; comments close **December 7**. (digitalpolicyalert.org)
- **FY2027 sugar TRQs (October 1 opening):** refined sugar and specialty sugar were both oversubscribed — pro rata allocations of **51.03027%** (refined) and **44.58212%** (specialty). (ghy.com)

USTR

- **October 8:** Invoked the **USMCA Rapid Response Labor Mechanism** to review whether workers at **GLM Components Mexico, S.A. de C.V.** (Puebla; auto parts) are being denied freedom of association and collective bargaining rights; the US has **suspended liquidation** of unliquidated entries of goods from the facility. (ustr.gov)
- **October 7:** Convened senior officials of **14 economies** on the margins of the OECD Trade Committee; issued a joint ministerial statement addressing structural excess capacity — the precursor to the 15-economy statement (see §3.6).
- **October 5:** Ambassador Greer hosted the **G20 Trade Ministers** in Milwaukee; discussions covered forced labor elimination, updating the MFN principle, denouncing weaponization of food trade, and excess capacity.
- **Section 301 four-year review (2018 actions):** USTR announced that the second four-year reviews of the July 6, 2018 and August 23, 2018 Section 301 actions (China Lists 2 and 3) concluded with the tariffs **remaining in place** — additional duties generally 7.5% to 25%, some higher after later modifications (Federal Register notice published October 7).
- **2027 USMCA joint review:** comments and hearing requests due **January 12, 2027**.
- **ASEAN tariff-rate quota proposal:** USTR is considering a three-year TRQ for Bangladesh, Cambodia, Indonesia and Malaysia that could exempt products containing US cotton and textile inputs from Section 301 forced-labor tariffs — still under

consideration. Malaysia holds to its October 2025 Agreement on Reciprocal Trade (19% rate); Indonesia treats its February 2026 "New Golden Age" pact as binding; Thailand is assessing; Vietnam is leveraging diplomatic proximity. (asiadaily.org)

- **Brazil:** after a September 30 meeting with Greer, Brazilian negotiator Rosa said Brazil seeks a full tariff reduction — including on Section 232 steel, aluminum and auto-part tariffs — and both sides agreed to appoint a working group to define the scope of trade issues; he called the Brazil-specific 25% Section 301 tariff "the most terrible tariff." (internationaltradetoday.com)

BIS — export controls

- **"U.S. content" guidance (FR publication scheduled October 14):** defines how to calculate "U.S. content" for Canadian and Mexican products qualifying for USMCA preferential treatment under Section 232 metals proclamation 11032 — (1) value of parts wholly obtained, entirely produced, or substantially transformed in the US; (2) to the extent not already counted, value of steel melted and poured, aluminum smelted and cast, and copper smelted and cast in the US. The two methodologies cannot be combined. Practical effect: qualifying importers of USMCA mobile industrial equipment (forklifts, graders, cranes, backhoes, bulldozers) can reduce the Section 232 tariff from **25% to an effective 15% floor** where at least 40% of value is US content; new HTS subheading **9903.82.22** reports non-US content (or US content exceeding 40%), while 9903.82.21 covers qualifying US content up to 40%. (kpmg.com)
- **Affiliates Rule:** BIS's September 2025 interim final rule extends Entity List, Military End-User List and SDN restrictions to foreign entities 50% or more owned by listed parties. Its one-year suspension (part of the Busan Agreement, effective November 10, 2025) is scheduled to end **November 10** unless extended. The September 23 US–China agreement extending the Busan framework through January 10, 2027 is expected to carry a matching extension, but **no Federal Register notice** has yet been published. Trade counsel advise preparing on the assumption the rule could return. (jdsupra.com)
- **Aircraft-parts licenses to COMAC:** Reuters reported October 1 (unnamed sources) that Commerce has slowed export licenses for aircraft parts bound for China, including shipments to state-owned COMAC, and is considering new rules on landing gear and hydraulic-fluid licensing. (investornews.com)

Federal Register — AD/CVD, October 5–8

New AD/CVD investigations instituted on **amine compounds from China** (alleged dumping margins up to 476%; ITC preliminary due November 13) and **railway tank cars and parts from Mexico** (ITC preliminary due November 16); **final affirmative CVD** on chromium trioxide from India; **preliminary affirmative CVD + critical circumstances** on CBS from China; preliminary AD review results on rebar from Türkiye; preliminary intent to rescind the AD review on mattresses from Poland; five-year sunset reviews scheduled on seamless pipe (Russia, South Korea, Czechia, Ukraine); a revised schedule on corrugated die-cut cardboard boxes (China, Malaysia, Türkiye). Full table in §4. (federalregister.gov)

Standing items

- **Polysilicon Section 232:** unchanged. December 4 effectiveness stands (MIPs $21/kg poly, $100/kg wafers, $0.22/W cells, $0.38/W modules; 15% ad valorem on derivatives; anti-surge restrictions run September 22–December 4). US module median price reached $0.38/W by late September, up ~40.7% from $0.27/W in August.
- **US–China truce:** the Busan framework extension to **January 10, 2027** stands (announced by Secretary Bessent September 23); the White House has not formally documented it. Rare-earth shipments have not returned to agreed levels; the April 2025 controls on seven rare earth elements were never suspended. Section 301 exclusions for 178 China products expire November 10.
- **US–China "30-for-30":** the White House announced the framework September 27 and both governments published reciprocal tariff-relief lists September 28 (~$30B each side: 77 US import lines covering consumer goods, 1,619 Chinese lines covering farm goods, food, timber, coal and medical equipment). No tariff reductions have taken effect yet; US-side relief needs a Section 301 public comment process. MOFCOM's English portal carries its published information on the framework. (lexblog.com)

---

6. World policy by region

Europe

- **EU–China:** see §3.1. In parallel, the **Franco-German rapid-reaction proposal** (October 5) asks the Commission for an instrument against "systemic market-distorting practices" — dumping, widespread subsidies, restrictions on currency convertibility — with German officials invoking a tool "as powerful as the Section 301 tariffs imposed by the United States or China's restrictions on exports of critical minerals." The proposal calls for swifter trade-defence tools, more investigations, a broader sectoral approach (flagging chemicals, PET and hybrid vehicles), plus two additional instruments on diversification and economic security. The Commission welcomed the letter; EU leaders discuss it at the October 15 summit. MOFCOM publicly responded to media reports on the "European version of Section 301" proposal. (lapost.com)
- **UK:** the government is drawing up a potential package of tariffs of **up to 45%** on Chinese-made EVs, matching the EU's combined rate. Business Secretary Reynolds now calls the decision "finely balanced" after telling Auto Express in September the UK had no plans to raise tariffs. Brussels has signalled UK products could be excluded from "Made in Europe" industrial-policy benefits if the UK does not align; 58% of UK auto exports go to the EU vs ~4% to China; Chinese brands took more than 15% of UK new-car registrations in the first eight months of 2026 (223,000 cars), up from 4% in 2023. A DBT spokesperson said no tariffs have been introduced and no final decision made. (fleetnews.co.uk, britishchambers.org.uk)

- **Digital trade files:** the **EU–South Korea Digital Trade Agreement** faces an MEP amendment deadline of October 8 (data-flow rules, source-code protection, permanent ban on customs duties on electronic transmissions); the **EU–Canada summit in Montréal (October 29–30)** is expected to complete negotiations on a Digital Trade Agreement and a minerals/competition-cooperation package; the Commission has put forward signature proposals for the **EU–India FTA** with a digital chapter. (euperspectives.eu, dig.watch, globallawexperts.com)
- **EU–Indonesia FTA:** technical negotiations concluded September 2025; the legal text (removing tariffs on the majority of goods with safeguards and quotas for sensitive goods) is in institutional review, with formal signing expected before the end of the EU's 2026 financial year. Negotiations with the Philippines, Thailand and Malaysia are at an advanced stage. (lupicinio.com)
- **European Parliament:** voted October 7 to denounce China's economic practices and its position on Ukraine.

China

- **P-nitrotoluene anti-dumping probe** (opened October 3; see §4). MOFCOM noted the EU has opened **28 trade-remedy investigations** against China since 2025, roughly half involving chemicals, and called for disputes to be resolved through dialogue.
- **Graham Act:** Beijing rejected "long-arm jurisdiction" and interference in normal trade cooperation, opposes unilateral sanctions lacking a UN Security Council mandate, and reserves the right to protect its companies (Foreign Ministry, September 19, reiterated in reporting this week). China was the second-largest buyer of Russian crude in 2025 at ~1.3M bpd.
- **Overcapacity statement:** MOFCOM said October 9 that China would respond "as necessary" if the 15-economy statement were used as a pretext for measures harming Chinese interests; China did not sign.
- **MOFCOM English portal** was reachable on October 12 (http://english.mofcom.gov.cn/), carrying the spokesperson's response on the Franco-German proposal and the published "30-for-30" framework information.

India

- **US trade-deal talks "reached a plateau"** (Finance Minister Sitharaman, October 5); further concessions may be difficult. The MEA warned September 17 that the Graham Act could have implications "not just for the bilateral relationship but also the international energy market," and stressed energy security for 1.4 billion people. Oil Minister Puri pointed to diversification options (Guyana, Brazil, Canada, Suriname, Namibia). India was the largest buyer of Russian crude in 2025 at ~1.6M bpd.
- India joined the **15-economy overcapacity statement** (October 7) and is among 16 economies covered by USTR's March 2026 Section 301 excess-capacity investigation. The WTO dispute over its ICT tariffs with Chinese Taipei was postponed to October 27.

Türkiye

- No new Turkish government statement on the Graham Act was identified this week (Türkiye: ~282,000 bpd of Russian crude in 2025, third-tier buyer). Türkiye signed the 15-economy overcapacity statement.

Canada

- **No new retaliatory measures** October 5–12. Canada's mirrored 15%/25%/50% counter-tariffs (in force September 8, ~C$27.6B) stand; steel and aluminum rates were raised from 25% to 50% to match US rates; goods in transit on September 8 were exempt; existing auto counter-tariffs continue. Ottawa announced a **C$7.5B** package of worker and business support measures. Negotiating deadlock persists (Greer: sticking points "quite difficult"; Carney: supply management is non-negotiable).

Brazil

- **Zero duties** on microphones, musical instruments and household sewing machines took effect October 1 (Gecex/Camex Resolution No. 926/2026; duties previously reached 18–20%). Brazil agreed a **working group with USTR** (September 30) to define the scope of a tariff-reduction agreement; Rosa called the Brazil-specific 25% Section 301 tariff "the most terrible tariff."

Japan

- Amended its Export Trade Control Order on October 6 to add further goods to its Russia export ban covering items that could strengthen Russia's industrial base; takes effect **October 16** — one day before the Graham Act deadline. (globalsanctions.com)

ASEAN and Australia

- **ASEAN TRQ proposal:** see §5 (USTR considering a three-year TRQ for Bangladesh, Cambodia, Indonesia and Malaysia for goods containing US cotton/textile inputs).
- **Australia:** DFAT declined to join a UK-led statement by 12 governments considering or committing to restrictions on trade with Israeli businesses in West Bank settlements, citing practical challenges; it said it is pursuing further targeted measures with partners instead (late September; the week's only reported Australian trade-restriction position).

Multilateral

- **WTO General Council (October 5–6):** members held a two-day reform meeting; DG Okonjo-Iweala urged moving from process to substance. Dispute-settlement reform: DSB Chair Ambassador Patriota (Brazil) will continue informal consultations; nearly 60 speakers took the floor. Fisheries subsidies: members urged to avoid a "sunsetting" of the agreement; new ideas requested in agriculture. Electronic Commerce Agreement: wide majority support for digital-trade predictability, but questions on legal foundations, use of WTO resources and the DG's depositary role. Investment

Facilitation for Development: participation expanded to **131 members**. MC15: no dates fixed. (logisticsnews.ph)

- **WTO disputes:** the **CBAM panel (DS639, Russia vs EU)** was established September 25 at Russia's second request, with **India as third party**; the EU will participate while declining direct engagement with Russia; the Appellate Body remains unable to hear appeals. The **Türkiye–China EV dispute (DS629)** panel-report consideration was deferred to October 27 at the parties' joint request; the **India–Chinese Taipei ICT-tariff** ruling adoption was postponed to October 27. Colombia and 130 members pushed for the 110th time to start Appellate Body selection; the US again voiced concerns. Cambodia was admitted to the MPIA. (reuters.com)
- **UNCTAD Trade and Development Report 2026** (October 9): see §3.4. UNCTAD's tariff-context analysis (September 17) found US tariff rates jumped from an average 2.8% before 2025 to over 20% by early September; 16 developing countries (incl. 5 LDCs) now face tariffs above 25%; LDC trade-weighted average tariffs doubled to 19% during the pause period and climbed to 27% in September; Asia-Oceania developing countries rose from 3% to 21%; Latin America and the Caribbean from below 0.5% to 18%. (un.org)
- **WCO:** the **HS 2028 amendments** were released — 299 sets of changes producing 1,229 headings and 5,852 subheadings (6 new headings, 428 new subheadings created; 5 headings, 172 subheadings deleted), focused on health-emergency preparedness, epidemic response and environmental protection; entry into force **1 January 2028**, with a two-year implementation window — flagged this week as a key forward deadline for tariff-classification teams. The EU–WCO Rules of Origin Africa Programme held its final Training of Trainers workshop for the Kenya Association of Manufacturers (opened October 1). (wcoesarocb.org)
- **ITC:** no new Trade Map or trade-statistics releases dated October 5–12 were identified from public reporting.

---

7. Enforcement actions

Action	Target	Date	Status	Source
Withhold Release Orders (forced labor)	Mitra Aneka Rezeki (MAR), Hardaya Inti Plantation (HIP) — Indonesian palm oil and derivatives	Sept 29, 2026	In force; 60 active WROs + 8 Findings total	thompsonhine.com
US sanctions (OFAC)	22 tankers plus individuals/companies linked to Iran's oil trade	Oct 8, 2026	Designated	gcaptain.com
US sanctions (OFAC GL135)	Authorises Russian diesel imports	Oct 9, 2026 – Apr 7, 2027	In force	nationpress.com
UK sanctions	5 LNG carriers (Sovcomflot-linked tightening with Japan)	Oct 1, 2026	Designated	hellenicshippingnews.com

Action	Target	Date	Status	Source
Japan export control	Expanded Russia export ban	Oct 16, 2026	Takes effect	globalsanctions.com
US import bans (Section 338)	Canadian motorcycles, whey, molasses, nonalcoholic beer, alcohol, dairy (~$967M)	Sept 29, 2026	In force	asrwe.com
USTR Rapid Response Mechanism	GLM Components Mexico (Puebla; auto parts) — liquidation suspended	Oct 8, 2026	Review open	ustr.gov
CBP	Phase 3 IEEPA refund process (CAPE)	Oct 6, 2026	Open; comments due Nov 4	thompsonhine.com

WRO detail (MAR/HIP): CBP's September 29 orders cover palm oil and derivatives from Mitra Aneka Rezeki and Hardaya Inti Plantation. information reviewed: worker interviews, payroll slips, harvest quotas, photographs, NGO/government reports, news media, academic research. Workers at MAR showed **nine** ILO forced-labor indicators (including retention of identity documents and isolation); HIP showed **seven** (debt bondage, wage withholding, deception, excessive overtime, intimidation, abusive conditions, abuse of vulnerability). Detentions are immediate at all US ports; importers may export, destroy, or prove clean sourcing.

---

8. Data releases

Release	Date	Headline figure	Source
Census/BEA FT-900 — US trade, Aug 2026	Oct 6	Deficit $105.6B (+13.7%); imports record $420.8B; Jan–Aug deficit −19.9% y/y	bea.gov
WTO Global Trade Outlook and Statistics (Oct update)	Oct 8	Merchandise volume +3.9% in 2026 (from 1.9%), +4.1% in 2027; services cut to 3.3%; AI goods 47% of trade growth	dig.watch
UNCTAD Trade and Development Report 2026	Oct 9	Record $35T world trade in 2025; global GDP 2.6% in 2026; Asia 60% of growth; India 7.3%	un.org
UNCTAD Global Trade Update (mid-year outlook)	Oct (window)	Merchandise trade growth 1.5–2.5% in 2026 real terms (from 4.7% in 2025)	gtreview.com
IMF World Economic Outlook (full report)	Due Oct 12–18 (Bangkok Annual Meetings)	Oct 6 pre-release: cost-of-living crises put 23M more people below extreme-poverty line 2021–24; baseline ~3% global growth in 2026	reuters.com
ECB — euro-area BoP, Q2 2026	Oct 2	Current account €265B (1.6% of GDP); chemicals/machines surpluses shrinking; energy deficit back on the books	ecb.europa.eu

Release	Date	Headline figure	Source
Destatis — German foreign trade, Aug 2026	Oct 8	Exports −0.8% m/m; surplus €19.5B; second straight monthly decline	destatis.de
Tax Foundation — Trump Tariffs Tracker (Sept 2026 vintage)	Living tracker	54% of US goods imports affected; applied rate 11.7%, effective 7.2%; $151.5B customs revenue in 2026, ~$1.5T 2026–2035; ~$820/household (2026); long-run GDP −0.4%	taxfoundation.org
Tax Foundation — Options for Reforming America's Tax Code 3.0	Oct 8 coverage	Repeal all tariffs, substitute a VAT; repeal would lose ~$1.8T through 2036	rethinking65.com
Yale Budget Lab — State of U.S. Tariffs	Living tracker	Statutory rate 11.0% now, 11.8% by year-end; ~0.7% consumer-price impact; ~$1,100/household; ~$1.9T over ten years; ~875,000 more people in poverty	budgetlab.yale.edu
UN Comtrade	Methodology notes only	IMTS 2026 White Cover; cross-border trade guidance — no new dataset vintage Oct 5–12	uncomtrade.org
USITC DataWeb / USA Trade Online	Routine monthly refresh	August 2026 detail now queryable	

```
%%{init: {'theme': 'base', 'themeVariables': {'xyChart': {'plotColorPalette':
'#2a9d8f'}}}}%%
xychart-beta
    title "Tariff burden per US household, 2026 (think-tank estimates)"
    x-axis ["Tax Foundation (~$820)", "Yale Budget Lab (~$1,100)"]
    y-axis "$" 0 --> 1300
    bar [820, 1100]
```

```
%%{init: {'theme': 'base', 'themeVariables': {'xyChart': {'plotColorPalette':
'#2a9d8f'}}}}%%
xychart-beta
    title "US tariff rate: statutory vs applied vs effective (%)"
    x-axis ["Statutory (Yale)", "Applied (TF)", "Effective (TF)"]
    y-axis "%" 0 --> 14
    bar [11.0, 11.7, 7.2]
```

Yale Budget Lab and Tax Foundation estimates, 2026. TF = Tax Foundation.

Analysis. The think-tank pair frames the household-cost debate. Tax Foundation's $820 and Yale's $1,100 are the two figures journalists quote; they differ on statutory-versus-effective rate treatment and the IEEPA refund mechanics. Yale's post-ruling analysis is the most complete current-law synthesis available: refund chaos creates "large revenue effects" that roughly offset the remaining tariffs' 2026 growth drag, with a persistent long-run cost of 0.1% of GDP (~$30B annually). Tax Foundation's book-length argument, repeal all tariffs and substitute a VAT, is the clearest policy-alternative articulation of the cycle. The WTO–

UNCTAD divergence (volume optimism vs. real-terms caution) is the frame for reading the autumn data flow.

---

9. Freight market

Container spot rates — Drewry World Container Index

The Drewry World Container Index closed its Thursday **October 8** assessment at **$4,351 per 40ft container, down 2% week on week**, attributed to weaker demand on the Transpacific and Asia–Europe trades during China's Golden Week. The prior assessment (October 1) had closed at $4,434, down 1%. Xeneta chief analyst Peter Sand said October 1 marked the post-Hormuz-crisis peak: Far East–US West Coast spot hit $8,346/FEU, East Coast $11,523/FEU, more than four times February 28 pre-crisis levels. Asia–Europe rates have now fallen for **13 consecutive weeks**. Drewry identifies the faster-than-expected Suez return as the principal threat to carrier rate-support efforts: restored capacity is doing what restored capacity does. Drewry expects rates to remain stable in the week ahead, noting carriers' attempted higher FAK rates on Asia–Europe in the second half of October and a possible US-bound rebound after the holiday under the extended US–China truce.

Lane (40ft)	8 Oct 2026	W/W change	Source
WCI composite	$4,351	−2%	Drewry
Shanghai → Rotterdam	$3,337	−2%	Drewry
Shanghai → Genoa	$3,696	unchanged	Drewry
Shanghai → Los Angeles	$7,624	−3%	Drewry
Shanghai → New York	$10,220	−2%	Drewry
Rotterdam → New York (per FEU)	$3,091	−1%	Shipping Telegraph
Backhaul Rotterdam → Shanghai	$628	+2%	Shipping Telegraph

Blank-sailing counts (Drewry Container Capacity Insight): Transpacific — four blank sailings announced for the coming week, down from eleven this week (capacity increasing); Asia–Europe — six announced for next week, up from five.

```
%%{init: {'theme': 'base', 'themeVariables': {'xyChart': {'plotColorPalette':
'#2563eb'}}}}%%
xychart-beta
    title "WCI lane rates, 8 Oct 2026 ($/FEU)"
    x-axis ["SHA→RTM", "SHA→Genoa", "SHA→LA", "SHA→NY", "RTM→NY", "RTM→SHA BH"]
    y-axis "$/FEU" 0 --> 12000
    bar [3337, 3696, 7624, 10220, 3091, 628]
```

SHA = Shanghai; RTM = Rotterdam. Backhaul: Rotterdam→Shanghai.

```
%%{init: {'theme': 'base', 'themeVariables': {'xyChart': {'plotColorPalette':
'#1e3a5f'}}}}%%
xychart-beta
```

```
    title "WCI composite, last two weekly assessments"
    x-axis ["01 Oct (-1% w/w)", "08 Oct (-2% w/w)"]
    y-axis "$/FEU" 0 --> 5000
    bar [4434, 4351]
```

Freightos Baltic Index (FBX)

The FBX global index finished the week of **October 9** at **3,344 points**, effectively unchanged (3,348 at week's start).

Route	Rate (per FEU, 9 Oct 2026)	W/W change	Source
FBX global composite	3,344 points	−4 pts on the week	Baltic Exchange weekly report
FBX01 China/East Asia → US West Coast	$8,106	−$228	Baltic Exchange weekly report
FBX03 China/East Asia → US East Coast	$9,606	unchanged	Baltic Exchange weekly report
FBX11 China/East Asia → North Europe	$3,260	unchanged	Baltic Exchange weekly report
FBX13 China/East Asia → Mediterranean	$3,861	+$320	Baltic Exchange weekly report
FBX21 US East Coast → Europe	$1,182	+$108	Baltic Exchange weekly report

Supply Chain Dive (October 9, Freightos weekly): Asia–USWC spot $8,322 (−3%), USEC $9,606 (flat), with weather-related port backlogs in China keeping a floor under rates. Xeneta expects USEC $6,000–7,000 and USWC $4,500–5,500 in three months: "a sizable correction, but not a collapse."

Dry bulk — Baltic Exchange

The **Baltic Dry Index** finished Friday October 9 at **2,917 points, down 7.3% for the week**, its lowest since late August. The damage was concentrated in Capesize (index −13.9%, average daily earnings −$1,560 to $35,860) as Dalian iron ore touched an 18-month low; Panamax +2.2% and Supramax +1.4% held up.

Date	BDI	Capesize (earnings)	Panamax	Supramax	Source
Mon 5 Oct	3,070	4,833 ($40,330)	2,364	1,790	Baird Maritime
Tue 6 Oct	3,002	4,638 ($38,561)	2,366	1,795	Baird Maritime
Wed 7 Oct	2,994	4,597 ($38,188)	2,384	1,800	Baird Maritime
Thu 8 Oct	2,973	4,512 ($37,420)	2,410	1,808	Baird Maritime
Fri 9 Oct	2,917	4,340 ($35,860)	2,424	1,814	Baltic Exchange weekly report

```
%%{init: {'theme': 'base', 'themeVariables': {'xyChart': {'plotColorPalette':
'#7c3aed'}}}}%%
```

```
xychart-beta
    title "FBX lane rates, 9 Oct 2026 ($/FEU)"
    x-axis ["FBX01 USWC", "FBX03 USEC", "FBX11 N.Europe", "FBX13 Med", "FBX21 US-EU"]
    y-axis "$/FEU" 0 --> 11000
    bar [8106, 9606, 3260, 3861, 1182]
```

Lanes: FBX01 China/East Asia→US West Coast; FBX03 →US East Coast; FBX11 →North Europe; FBX13 →Mediterranean; FBX21 US East Coast→Europe.

```
%%{init: {'theme': 'base', 'themeVariables': {'xyChart': {'plotColorPalette':
'#d97706'}}}}%%
xychart-beta
    title "Baltic Dry Index daily closes, 5–9 Oct 2026"
    x-axis ["Mon 5 Oct", "Tue 6 Oct", "Wed 7 Oct", "Thu 8 Oct", "Fri 9 Oct"]
    y-axis "index" 0 --> 3500
    bar [3070, 3002, 2994, 2973, 2917]
```

Port and logistics disruptions

Red Sea / Suez return accelerates. Hapag-Lloyd confirmed the first westbound and eastbound sailings of the Gemini Cooperation's SE1 service through the Red Sea and Suez: the *Umm Qarn* departs Tanjung Pelepas for Suez on 27 October and Algeciras on 5 December. The Premier Alliance (ONE, HMM, Yang Ming) restores its Southeast Asia–North Europe FE1 loop to Suez from October, its first break from Cape routing since January 2024, with the 8,110 TEU *ONE Continuity* departing Laem Chabang on 17 October. COSCO was scheduled to make its first westbound Suez transit in more than two years on 4 October. MSI estimates ~35% of Asia–Europe sailings now use the Red Sea; Linerlytica counts 140+ boxships (2M+ TEU) returned since May; Suez container net tonnage January–August was 72.1M tonnes (+54.2% y/y). Two caveats travel with the return: the EU's Aspides escort operation has acknowledged warship coverage is insufficient for all requests, the binding limit on further return; and Drewry's Container Forecaster finds the economic benefit to carriers of the Suez return is thin, roughly $1M per round voyage saved vs the Cape, yet carriers are returning anyway, and the restored capacity is pressuring Asia–Europe rates (see the 13-week slide above). (splash247.com, container-news.com)

Asian port congestion. Typhoon-season congestion pushed global schedule reliability below 50% for the first time since the pandemic (Sea-Intelligence), with Asian congestion possibly lasting into mid-2027; congestion absorbs 12% of effective vessel capacity (DHL Forwarding) and ~10.9% of the container fleet (~3.76M TEU); average delays for late vessels reached 6.81 days, the highest since March 2022. Golden Week (October 1–7) softened demand; Shanghai is expected to remain heavily congested into mid-to-late October. (worldcargonews.com, ti-insight.com)

Black Sea attacks escalated. The bulker *Royad Mammadov* sank off Romania (two crew killed); days later drone strikes off Bulgaria sank the bulker *Alfa Watan* and left *Able* ablaze. Grain corridors are disrupted and insurance premiums are spiking. India and Liberia, as co-chairs of the Group of Friends on Safety and Security of Shipping and Seafarers, jointly condemned the attacks (October 9). (splash247.com)

Panama Canal. Transits rise to 33 per day from October 15 (from 32) with draft restored to 49 feet; Neo-Panamax slots increase to 10 daily. El Niño risk ahead: NOAA expects the pattern to continue into early 2027. Carriers already surcharge: MSC $149/20ft ($297/40ft), CMA CGM Panama Canal Adjustment Factor $500/TEU.

Philippines. Manila empties crisis: a broker "digital protest" and trucker holiday (October 5–8) over carriers refusing empty returns for up to a month; the protest ended October 8 after terminals began continuously accepting empties. Separately, Hapag-Lloyd suspended all new bookings to Manila, Batangas and Subic through December 31, citing congestion and severe limits on depot/empty-return capacity. The two decisions are unrelated operationally: the booking suspension is a Philippines-specific empties problem, not a verdict on the Suez return (Hapag-Lloyd's own SE1 Suez sailing departs October 27). (portcalls.com)

Labour and inland waterways. A German dockworker strike was averted October 2 (ver.di deal ends warning strikes at Hamburg/Bremerhaven). But historically low water at the Rhine's Kaub gauge has effectively halted loaded barge passage; low-water surcharges reached €1,280/FEU (Contargo) and $1,350/FEU (Hapag-Lloyd). Vancouver dockworkers protested automation and AI (October 2). No verifiable reports of a new US ILA East/Gulf Coast strike in the window were found.

Carrier surcharges and services. CMA CGM: peak season surcharges on Asia–Africa (up to $750/TEU Far East→Durban from October 22; $200/TEU SE Asia→northern West Africa from October 15), West Africa PSS increases from October 22, Asia→Latin America +$1,000/container from October 15, Asia–Mediterranean FAK rates October 19–31, and $1,000/reefer PSS North Europe→Arabian Gulf from mid-October. Maersk: PSS across three trades; ends ASAS2 vessel-sharing with CMA CGM on Asia–East Coast South America (final sailing Shanghai December 8). Fleet: MSC ordered six LNG dual-fuel megamax vessels (~21,700 TEU each) for 2029–2030 delivery; its orderbook exceeds 170 ships / 3M+ TEU. (container-news.com)

Sanctions and Arctic shipping. The UK sanctioned five LNG carriers (October 1); the UK and Japan are tightening the net around Sovcomflot-linked vessels. Arctic LNG 2 has exported 0.95Mt in 2026 (all since July). China completed its first season of regular weekly container service China–Europe via the Northern Sea Route (October 7); a South Korean container ship completed the country's first commercial Arctic round trip to Europe (October 10). Tanker M&A: Trafigura bought seven tankers from SFL Corp (~$175M profit to the seller); Trafigura spin-off Volare Shipping listed in Oslo (October 6). (hellenicshippingnews.com, gcaptain.com)

Mexico. Auto exports posted their biggest slump of the year in September, attributed by analysts to US tariffs (INEGI data via gCaptain, October 8).

Vendor intelligence

- **TradeInt:** Türkiye's Ministry of Trade × TradeInt grant (announced September 30, covered in this week's press) — funded access to shipment records, customs filings

and bill-of-lading data across 200+ countries for Turkish consulting firms; TradeInt's data review put Türkiye's 2025 exports at $269.7B (September a record $22.6B). (citybuzz.co)

---

10. Policy timelines

```
timeline
    title EU-China trade track, September-October 2026
    18 September 2026 : Graham Act signed (secondary tariff deadline set: October 18)
    03 October 2026 : China opens anti-dumping probe into EU p-nitrotoluene
(Announcement No. 44)
    05 October 2026 : France and Germany propose rapid-reaction EU trade instrument
    07 October 2026 : 15 economies sign US-led joint statement on structural
overcapacity
    08-09 October 2026 : EU-China Trade and Investment Consultations in Beijing (hybrid
export understanding announced)
    15 October 2026 : EU leaders' summit in Brussels decides next steps on hybrid deal
and trade-defence proposal
    18 October 2026 : Graham Act tariff-determination deadline (up to 500% on Russian
goods; up to 100% secondary tariffs)
    10 November 2026 : China rare-earth export-control suspension expires (automatic
snapback unless extended)
    10 January 2027 : US-China Busan truce extension expires
```

```
timeline
    title US-Canada dispute sequence, August-October 2026
    22 August 2026 : US 50% Section 338 tariffs on Canadian goods take effect
    08 September 2026 : Canada's mirrored 15%/25%/50% counter-tariffs take effect;
presidential directive to remove Canadian goods from GSA schedules
    15 September 2026 : US Section 338 product list re-scoped (additions at 50%)
    29 September 2026 : US import bans on Canadian motorcycles, whey, molasses,
nonalcoholic beer, alcohol, dairy take effect; CBP issues two palm-oil WROs
    01 October 2026 : FY2027 customs user fees take effect (broker permit fee to
$190.88)
    06 October 2026 : CBP opens Phase 3 of IEEPA tariff refund process (CAPE)
    04 October 2026 : No written ruling yet in 25-state lawsuit over Section 301
forced-labor tariffs
    November-December 2026 : Court challenges expected; IEEPA refund scope litigation
continues
```

```
timeline
    title Freight market events, October 2026
    01 October 2026 : Xeneta calls post-Hormuz container spot rate peak (USWC
$8,346/FEU, USEC $11,523/FEU)
    02 October 2026 : German dock strike averted (ver.di agreement); ILA low-water
surcharges reach $1,350/FEU
    05 October 2026 : Hapag-Lloyd suspends Manila bookings through year-end; WTO
General Council reform meeting opens
    08 October 2026 : Drewry WCI falls 2% to $4,351/FEU; WTO raises 2026 trade forecast
```

```
to 3.9%; Descartes October Global Shipping Report released
    09 October 2026 : UNCTAD Trade and Development Report 2026 published; FBX closes at 3,344 points; BDI closes at 2,917 (-7.3% w/w)
    09-11 October 2026 : Houthi embargo on Saudi Arabia declared; strikes on two Saudi airports; Hormuz tanker attacks peak for the week
    12 October 2026 : This briefing; IMF-World Bank Annual Meetings begin in Bangkok (October WEO due)
    15 October 2026 : Panama Canal raises transits to 33/day, draft to 49 ft, Neo-Panamax slots to 10/day
    17 October 2026 : Premier Alliance FE1 inaugural Suez return (ONE Continuity, Laem Chabang)
    27 October 2026 : Hapag-Lloyd Umm Qarn westbound SE1 sailing via Red Sea and Suez
```

---

11. Upcoming deadlines & events (next 90 days)

Date	Event
Oct 14, 2026	BIS "U.S. content" guidance for USMCA mobile industrial equipment takes effect (FR publication)
Oct 15, 2026	EU leaders' summit, Brussels — decides on EU–China hybrid-export understanding, Franco-German rapid-reaction trade tool, Made in Europe rules
Oct 15, 2026	Panama Canal: transits to 33/day, draft to 49 ft, Neo-Panamax slots to 10/day
Oct 16, 2026	Japan's expanded Russia export ban takes effect
Oct 17, 2026	Premier Alliance FE1 inaugural Suez return (ONE Continuity, Laem Chabang)
Oct 18, 2026	Graham Act tariff-determination deadline: up to 500% duties on Russian goods; up to 100% secondary duties on top Russian-energy buyers without waiver
Oct 19, 2026	Commerce initiation decision due: amine compounds AD/CVD (China)
Oct 23, 2026	Registration/comment deadline: China's anti-dumping probe into EU p-nitrotoluene
Oct 27, 2026	DSB: India–Chinese Taipei ICT-tariff ruling adoption; Türkiye–China EV panel report consideration
Oct 27, 2026	Hapag-Lloyd Umm Qarn westbound SE1 sailing via Red Sea and Suez (Tanjung Pelepas)
Oct 29–30, 2026	EU–Canada summit, Montréal — expected completion of Digital Trade Agreement negotiations
Nov 4, 2026	CBP IEEPA-refund information-collection comments due
Nov 10, 2026	China rare-earth export-control suspension expires (automatic snapback unless extended)
Nov 10, 2026	Scheduled end of BIS Affiliates Rule suspension (extension to Jan 10, 2027 expected but not yet published)
Nov 10, 2026	Section 301 exclusions for 178 China products expire (extended through this date under truce)
Nov 13 / Nov 16, 2026	ITC preliminary determinations: amine compounds (China) / railway tank cars (Mexico)
Dec 4, 2026	Polysilicon Section 232 MIPs + 15% tariff take effect
Dec 7, 2026	CBP Low-Value Shipments proposed-rule comments close

Date	Event
Before Dec 2026	First technical meetings of the 15-economy overcapacity sectoral platforms
Jan 2027	EU–China ministerial video meeting
Jan 10, 2027	US–China Busan truce extension expires
Jan 12, 2027	2027 USMCA joint review public comments due
Jan 1, 2028	WCO HS 2028 amendments enter into force (299 change sets; classification teams should plan now)

---

12. Sources & methodology

Coverage window: October 5–12, 2026.

Trade news & analysis: FreightWaves, The Loadstar, Splash247, gCaptain, Hellenic Shipping News, Container News, Supply Chain Dive, Logistics Management, Air Cargo News, Port Technology International, JOC (headlines only), Freightmate/Sea Intelligence/ILA Industry Insights via trade press, TradeInt public announcements via press coverage, Breakwave Advisors (tanker-attack data via shipbroker Gibson).

US policy: whitehouse.gov fact sheets, cbp.gov (via trade advisories), ustr.gov press releases, federalregister.gov (AD/CVD notices, Section 301 review), bis.doc.gov (via KPMG/JD Supra analysis), internationaltradetoday.com (headlines), JD Supra law-firm analysis (Troutman Pepper Locke on Section 301 forced-labor tariffs; Miller Canfield on the BIS Affiliates Rule and Section 338), Thompson Hine, GHY International, Withum, Akin Gump, Bell Nunnally, Mondaq (Graham Act analysis; OFAC General License 135 analysis), KPMG Tax News Flash, Digital Policy Alert, LexBlog (U.S.-China Board of Trade "30-for-30").

World governments: ec.europa.eu/DG Trade (via press coverage), gov.uk Department for Business and Trade (via press), cbsa-asfc.gc.ca/canada.ca (via press), english.mofcom.gov.cn (accessed directly October 12), METI/Japan Customs (via Global Sanctions), Brazil Camex/Gecex resolutions (via Datamar), national trade ministry reporting for India, Türkiye, Brazil, Australia and ASEAN states.

Multilateral: wto.org (General Council October 5–6, disputes DS639/DS629, reform reporting), unctad.org (Trade and Development Report 2026, October Global Trade Update), wcoomd.org (HS 2028 amendments, rules-of-origin programme), ITC (no new releases in window).

Data portals: Census/BEA FT-900 (August 2026, released October 6), USITC DataWeb / USA Trade Online, WTO Global Trade Outlook October update, UN Comtrade (methodology notes), Eurostat/ECB statistical releases, World Bank data portals, IMF (pre-release WEO research; full October WEO due October 12–18).

Think tanks & research: Tax Foundation (Trump Tariffs Tracker, September 2026 vintage; Options for Reforming America's Tax Code 3.0), Yale Budget Lab (State of U.S. Tariffs),

tradeintelligence.eu (no new public research in window; EU digital-trade files via EU Perspectives/Digital Watch/Global Law Experts).

Freight: Drewry (World Container Index, October 8 assessment), Baltic Exchange (weekly report October 9), Freightos Baltic Index, Shanghai Containerized Freight Index / China Containerized Freight Index (via FreshPlaza), TAC Index, Baird Maritime (daily BDI), Xeneta (via FreightWaves/Air Cargo News), Descartes October Global Shipping Report (via Reuters), Sea-Intelligence, DHL Forwarding, DC Velocity, TI Insight, NRF Global Port Tracker, ILA Industry Insights.

Vendor intelligence: Descartes Systems Group and TradeInt public marketing and press announcements only (public blog and news content; no data-platform access, no logins, no competitor trade-data platform use).